CONNECT DAILY

Thursday 5 November 2026
themapsproject.com

A daily scan of national and South Yorkshire developments in education policy, inclusion, SEND, behaviour and accountability — weighted to primary and evidence sources, with links and a clear "so what for your school" line on the items that matter.

Useful? Forward it to a colleague. To join the circulation or partner with the network, get in touch.

TOP LINE

- Another quiet 24-48 hours - across DfE, Ofsted, safeguarding, funding and Sheffield/South Yorkshire sources, nothing new and properly corroborated cleared the bar, so today's edition runs short rather than padded.
- Reminder, not new: DfE's call for evidence on school exclusion reform now closes in two weeks, on 19 November.
- Still on the radar: DfE's accredited statistics release for autumn-term 2025/26 suspensions and permanent exclusions is due this month, with no exact day confirmed yet.

DATES FOR THE DIARY

19 Nov 2026 — DfE's call for evidence on school exclusion reform (white paper proposals on internal suspension, reintegration and parental engagement) closes.

Nov 2026 (exact day tbc) — DfE due to publish autumn 2025/26 suspensions and permanent exclusions statistics for England.

BEHAVIOUR & EXCLUSIONS

- **Exclusion-reform call for evidence: two weeks left to respond.** DfE's call for evidence on school exclusion reform - part of the 'Every child achieving and thriving' white paper - is seeking views from practitioners and researchers on proposals including wider use of internal suspension, reintegration support and parental engagement. It closes 19 November. (GOV.UK)

  → **For your school:** *Worth a quick nudge to anyone on the inclusion team who wants input in before the window closes.*

JARGON-BUSTER · INTERNAL SUSPENSION

Comes up throughout DfE's live exclusion-reform call for evidence.

Removing a pupil from their usual class or timetable for a fixed period while keeping them on the school site, supervised separately, rather than issuing a formal suspension. DfE is asking the sector whether wider, more consistent use of it could reduce reliance on off-site suspensions.

MAPS IN PRACTICE – TOOL SPOTLIGHT: SCHOOL+

A strong inclusion strategy is only as good as the cohort picture beneath it.

School+ is the MAPs cohort-vulnerability framework — it maps who your at-risk pupils are and why, giving your inclusion strategy an evidence base rather than a wish list. Explore School+

SOURCES MONITORED

Weighted official- and evidence-first. X is monitored for early signals from official accounts and named commentators, and corroborated against a primary source before anything is included.

Source	Type	What we track
OFFICIAL & STATUTORY		

Source	Type	What we track
DfE / GOV.UK	Government	Policy, funding, statutory guidance and statistics
Ofsted	Government	Inspection framework, report cards, annual report
Explore Education Statistics	Government data	Exclusions, suspensions, attendance, census data
House of Commons Library	Parliament	Neutral briefings on bills and policy
RESEARCH & EVIDENCE		
Education Endowment Foundation	Research	Evidence-based guidance, incl. inclusive teaching
NFER	Research	Assessment, workforce, disadvantage
Education Policy Institute	Think tank	Policy analysis and the disadvantage gap
Institute for Fiscal Studies	Think tank	School funding and spending analysis
FFT Education Datalab	Data analysis	Data-driven analysis of attainment and exclusions
INCLUSION & PREVENTION SPECIALISTS		
The Difference	Charity	Whole-school inclusion; "Who's Losing Learning?"
IPPR	Think tank	Lost learning, exclusions, SEND reform
Youth Endowment Fund	Research	What works to prevent youth violence & exclusion
Centre for Social Justice	Think tank	Exclusion tracker and social-mobility policy
Whole School SEND	Network	SEND practice, resources and reviews
SECTOR PRESS & COMMENTARY		
Schools Week	Press	Breaking sector news and investigations
Tes	Press	Practice, policy and workforce
The Guardian (Education)	Press	National coverage and comment
X (monitored)	Social	DfE, Ofsted, EEF and named voices — corroborated before use
LOCAL & REGIONAL		
The Star (Sheffield)	Local press	Local schools and Ofsted outcomes
Sheffield City Council	Local government	Council decisions, funding and local strategy
South Yorkshire MCA & Careers Hub	Regional	Regional skills, careers and funding

Connect Daily is part of Sheffield Connect. Compiled by Andy Marsden, Sector Inclusion Lead.

For circulation across the network and partners. Figures reflect the latest published data at the date of this brief.